

2024-25

THE GROVE GAZETTE



Grove Community
HOUSING ASSOCIATION



Your Community,
Your Voice,
Your News



EXCITING NEWS: PLANNING APPROVED FOR NEW HOMES ON NORTH QUEEN STREET!

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We're thrilled to share that planning approval has been granted for 31 new social homes on North Queen Street! Thanks to the dedication of local representatives and our board, this important milestone brings us closer to addressing housing needs in the Grove area.

The site presents some challenges, including varied ground levels and the need to preserve existing trees, but once complete, the development will provide homes for around 112 people, including four specially designed for those with physical disabilities. These homes will be allocated to families on the Common Selection Scheme waiting list, helping improve community wellbeing.

We're now focused on securing project approval and private finance. Over £6 million is being invested in these homes, with hopes to secure additional funding to build them to energy-efficient Passive House Standards—helping reduce fuel poverty and create sustainable housing for the future.

While funding cuts across Northern Ireland have limited new social home starts this year, we are actively lobbying for increased investment and raising awareness of the urgent need for more affordable homes here. Together with stakeholders, local politicians, and the community, we remain committed to building a thriving, eco-friendly neighbourhood for all.

- 15NO 3-PERSON, 2-BEDROOM
GENERAL NEED HOUSES
- 8NO 5-PERSON 3-BEDROOM
GENERAL NEED HOUSES
- 1NO 3-PERSON 2-BEDROOM
WHEELCHAIR BUNGALOW
- 1NO 6-PERSON 4-BEDROOM
WHEELCHAIR BUNGALOW
- 2NO 3-PERSON 2-BEDROOM
WHEELCHAIR APARTMENTS
- 4NO 3-PERSON 2-BEDROOM
GENERAL NEED CAT1 APARTMENTS



Introducing the Helping Hand Service Making Life Easier

Grove Housing is delighted to launch a new service designed to make life easier for our tenants! The “Helping Hand Service” offers a range of practical assistance to eligible tenants, from minor home repairs to helpful advice.

What can the Helping Hand Service do for you?

This service is available to new and existing tenants who meet eligibility. Our team can help with extra tasks that are normally tenant responsibility, therefore providing valuable savings to many.

- **Minor Plumbing:** Such as installing washing machines, bleeding radiators (tenant must provide fittings) and resetting heating controls.
- **Home Improvements:** Installing curtain rails and other items within your property.
- **Safety Measures:** Assisting with security chain installation and smoke alarm testing.
- **Accessibility Support:** Changing light bulbs in hard to reach areas and fitting handrails to help prevent falls.

- **Home Organisation:** Retrieving items from loft areas.
- **Waste Management Advice:** Providing guidance on bulky waste disposal.
- **Community Support:** Assisting local community organisations with item collection/delivery, e.g. local social supermarket.

Who is eligible for the Helping Hand Service?

- To be eligible, you must:
- Be in receipt of a means-tested benefit (e.g., Universal Credit, PIP, Housing Benefit, Income Support, etc.)
 - Have no other able-bodied person aged 18–59 in the property to assist.
 - Be 60 years of age or over, or have a disability that prevents you from carrying out the necessary work yourself.

What happens next?

If you are eligible, a member of our team will aim to contact you within two working days to discuss your request and provide an estimated timeframe for assistance.

Please note that if we are unable to gain access to your property on three separate occasions, we may unfortunately have to cancel your request.

How to request support

To see if you are eligible or to find out more about the Helping Hand Service, please:

Call into our office: 171 York Rd, Belfast BT15 3HB

Telephone: 028 9077 3330

Email: helpinghand@groveha.org.uk

Important Note: The Helping Hand Service does not cover electrical work. For safety reasons, all electrical work must be carried out by a qualified electrician.

We hope this new service will be a valuable asset to our tenants. Please don't hesitate to contact us if you have any questions.

Advancing Sustainability with EV Charging Points

Grove Housing enhances office sustainability

Grove Housing is excited to announce a new initiative to improve our office's sustainability. In partnership with Northern Ireland-based company Weev, we have installed grant-aided electric vehicle (EV) charging points at our office.

About Weev

Weev is known for its strong sustainability credentials and commitment to corporate social responsibility. They are actively working towards becoming a B-Corp, reflecting their dedication to high social and environmental performance standards.

Benefits for our office

The addition of EV charging points at our office aligns with our goal to create a more sustainable working environment. This initiative supports the use of electric vehicles, reducing carbon emissions, and provides convenient charging options for our staff.

Looking ahead

As we move forward, Grove Housing remains committed to exploring and implementing further sustainable initiatives. From enhancing our energy efficiency to adopting green building practices and promoting recycling within our office spaces, we strive to reduce our environmental footprint and foster a culture of sustainability among our team. Our ongoing efforts are a testament to our dedication to not only improving our immediate environment but also contributing positively to the wider community and the planet.

Thinking of going Electric?

Are you looking about at Electric Vehicles (EV)? Have a look at the Little Book of EV Myths, via the RAC for some impartial advice.



Meet New Team Members

Keelan McGaghran GCHA's new Director of Operations

I'm pleased to have joined Grove Community Housing Association as the new Director of Operations. I officially started in late August 2024 and bring with me a broad range of experience and a strong background in the social housing sector.

In my role, I'm responsible for overseeing the day-to-day operations of the Association and working closely with the team to ensure we continue to deliver high-quality, tenant-focused services.

Over the years, I've held a variety of roles within social housing, both here in the UK and overseas, including valuable experience in Australia. I've always been passionate about improving housing services and making a positive difference in people's lives, and that commitment continues to drive my work.

I bring a strong mix of skills in housing management, operational efficiency, team leadership, resident engagement, and strategic planning—all of which I hope will support the Association as we move into an exciting new chapter of growth and development. I'm also an active member of the Chartered Institute



of Housing (CIH) and recently completed a Master's degree in Governance and Management, which reflects my ongoing commitment to professional development and sector leadership.

Outside of work, I'm a devoted family man who enjoys spending quality time with my wife and our two young sons. I also volunteer as a coach for a youth football team, which gives me the opportunity to contribute and help support the next generation.

I'm excited to be part of the team at Grove and look forward to the positive impact we can achieve together for our tenants and the wider community.

Meet Pat - our new Compliance and Maintenance Officer

Hello, my name is Pat. I joined Grove Housing Association in November as the new Compliance and Maintenance Officer. I will also be delivering our latest new 'Helping Hand Service' (See page 3). With over 25 years' experience in the construction industry—especially in plumbing and heating for domestic and social housing—I'm excited to use my skills to help keep Grove residents' homes safe and well-maintained.

Outside of work, I enjoy watching my son play football in the South Belfast Youth League and spending time outdoors in local parks and beaches. I look forward to supporting the Grove community and contributing to residents' well-being.





Tenant Voice Group



On 3rd December the Tenant Voice Group held a productive meeting at our office, followed by a festive Christmas brunch and tree decoration. The meeting was called by Paul Stuart (Housing & Community Lead) and it covered a range of important topics aimed at enhancing community engagement and services.

Key highlights from the meeting include:

- **Dulux:** David McIlveen from Dulux provided an update on the environmental paint scheme for residents.
- **New Text Messaging Service:** The introduction of a new text messaging service was discussed. The aim of this service is to help improve communication with residents.
- **Warm Space Area:** The development of "Lottie's Lounge" in the Grove Community Offices was announced, providing a warm and welcoming space for residents.

- **Community Events:** Upcoming events were highlighted, including the Santa Sleigh Night on Thursday, December 12th, promising an evening of festive fun in the car park.
- **Community Engagement Fund:** New applications for the Community Engagement Fund were considered, supporting various community projects and initiatives.
- **Maintenance Service Update:** An overview of the new "Helping Hand" service was provided, detailing eligibility and the range of support available to residents.
- **New Homes Development:** Updates on current development projects and land availability were shared, outlining plans for new homes in the community.

The meeting concluded with a discussion on housing policy updates and other business matters, ensuring that residents' voices are heard, and their needs are addressed.



Why should I join the Tenant Voice Group?

As a tenant of Grove Community Housing Association, your knowledge of tenancy matters is integral to shaping the services we deliver.

What is the Tenant Voice Group?

The Tenant Voice Group members are volunteers who give up some of their free time to help improve the services and information tenants receive from Grove. Members also meet to have their say on a range of topics. They discuss policy changes, home improvement specifications, events held for tenants and lots more.

What's in it for me?

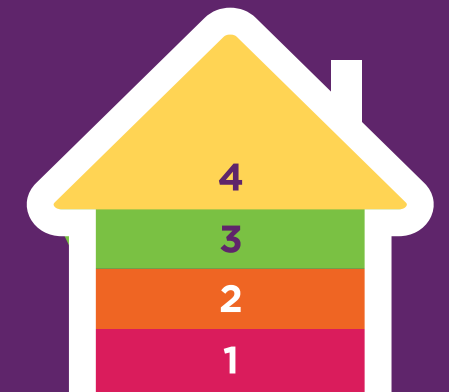
A chance to have your say and for your voice to be heard. To bring your expertise as a tenant. To attend training events, develop existing skills and learn new skills. This group will introduce you to other tenants. You will learn more about Grove and have your chance to respond to proposed changes.

What's in it for Grove?

Feedback from the Tenant Voice Group members gives us a well-rounded view of the business and ensures we are doing right by you.

How to apply

If you would like to join the Tenant Voice Group or find out how else you can get involved at Grove, please email Paul (Housing & Community Lead) housing@groveha.org.uk or contact him by phone **028 9077 3330**.



Level of Participation choice for tenants

LEVEL 1: Information and Communication

You receive regular information, participate in surveys, provide feedback and keep us up to date on how to communicate with you.

LEVEL 2: Group Structure

You help set up and participate in the local tenants groups. You also participate in the organisation and planning of social activities in the community.

LEVEL 3: Formal Based Tenant Group

You participate in a broader Tenant's Forum which looks at the work of the Association, scrutinises our activities and policies and engages in our business for the benefit of all tenants.

LEVEL 4: Governance Structure

You agree to serve on the Board of Grove Community Housing Association having influence in its strategic direction and how it is governed.

Get in touch!

Do you have an idea you'd like to share, or a story to tell, or comments about our services?

Please get in touch with an email to: housing@groveha.org.uk

If you have any complaints or problems they should still be addressed directly to our offices.

T: 028 9077 3330

(Please note we are unable to respond to anonymous emails)

GROVE'S HALLOWEEN BASH

SPOOKS, STORIES & SMILES BRING COMMUNITY TOGETHER!



Grove Community Housing Association's Halloween event on 22nd October was a frightfully fun success! Families and friends gathered for an afternoon packed with activities, delicious treats, and festive community spirit.

Children enjoyed spooky storytelling by local resident Laura Sage, got creative in colouring and pumpkin-carving contests, and won exciting prizes from Dulux Paints and GCHA. Donations of pumpkins, sweets, and party packs from Asda and Lidl added an extra sprinkle of magic to the celebration.

Community Police Officers and Dulux Paint reps joined in the fun, while Grove's own staff kept everyone fed with tasty pizza and snacks. The highlight? A surprise petting farm in the office, letting families meet and cuddle furry friends for a truly unforgettable day.

Thanks to everyone who joined and helped make this Halloween one to remember!



FUN AT THE CHRISTMAS WREATH MAKING EVENT!



On the 9th December, Grove Community Housing Association hosted a enjoyable Christmas Wreath Making event in their boardroom. The event ran from 10am to 1pm and 9 members of the Tenant Voice Group attended.

This wonderful event was organised by Grove Community Housing Association in collaboration with Joan Totten and Jeanette Baird from North Belfast Alternatives. Joan and Jeanette brought all the necessary wreaths and decorations, as well as the tools needed to create the festive wreaths. They assisted everyone and guided them through the process of making their own beautiful wreaths.

The atmosphere was filled with joy as the group chatted, laughed, and enjoyed the lively Christmas music playing in the background. This set the perfect scene for a festive and creative morning.

In addition to the wreath making, Terry Boyd joined the group, adding to the festive spirit, and posed for a picture with everyone. This added a lovely touch to the event and captured the joyous moment.

To top it all off, everyone indulged in an array of delicious treats including buns, sweets, and refreshing beverages such as tea, coffee, and Shloer. Lunch was also provided by Bluebells and included a variety of hot and cold foods, ensuring that everyone was well-fed and satisfied.

Overall, the Christmas Wreath Making event was a resounding success, filled with holiday spirit, creativity, and friendship. It was a wonderful way to bring the community together and celebrate the festive season.



Santa's Sleigh and Reindeer Event

A Fun Day on 12th December

We are thrilled to share the highlights of our Santa's Sleigh and Reindeer Event, held on 12th December. It was our biggest turnout yet, and everyone had an amazing time!

Fun with Animals

The reindeer and baby goats were a hit with both kids and adults. Everyone enjoyed petting and feeding these gentle animals, making it a memorable experience for all.

Yummy Food

We were delighted to have the PSNI provide delicious hot food for the event. The warm, tasty meals were perfect for the chilly day and much appreciated by all attendees.

Excitement in the Air

The highlight of the day was the arrival of Santa and his elf on a big sleigh. The children were overjoyed to see them, and Santa took the time to listen to each child's Christmas wish, spreading holiday cheer all around.

Colouring Competition

We also held a colouring competition, and the winners were thrilled with their cuddly toy prizes, courtesy of Dulux. The creativity and effort put into each colouring page were impressive, making it a tough job for the judges to select the winners.

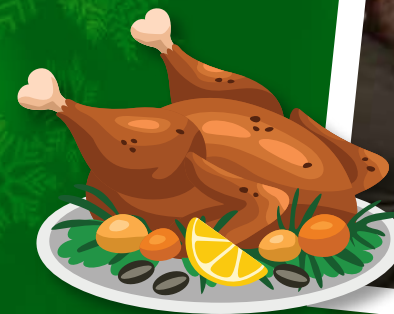


Special Guests

We were honoured to have some special guests at the event, including Board members and notable figures like Prof Paddy Gray OBE and Seamus Leheny, CEO of NIFHA. Their presence and support added to the festive spirit.

Thank you to everyone who attended and made the day so special! Your participation and enthusiasm contributed to the success of the event. We look forward to organising more exciting events in the future.

Christmas Dinner 2024



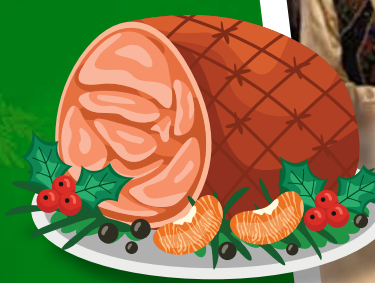
A Fun Celebration for Our Older Tenants

On 16th December, we held a Christmas dinner for our senior tenants at crusaders Football Club. This place was perfect because it was easy for everyone to get to, even in the cold winter. It provided a cozy and festive atmosphere that made everyone feel welcome.

It was a great turnout, with over 20 people joining us, including our Chairman Brian Dunn, Chief Executive Agnes Crawford, Director of Operations Keelan McGaghran, and other staff members.

Our staff team and residents welcomed the opportunity to get to know each other better over a delicious Christmas lunch. They chatted, pulled crackers, and had a wonderful time. The room was filled with laughter as everyone shared stories and enjoyed each other's company. The Crusaders FC staff were friendly and polite, serving a three-course meal.

Our photographer did a fantastic job capturing the happy moments and festive decorations, helping to create lasting memories from the day. The event ran for just over two hours, but with such a great atmosphere and so many smiles, the time seemed to fly by. It was wonderful to see so many residents come together to celebrate the season, and the sense of community made it a truly special occasion. We're already looking forward to more events like this in the future.





Easter Fun at Grove!

What a 'Hoppy Time' we had at our Spring Event!

Our Spring event at Grove was a wonderful, fun-filled day for the whole community! Kids loved meeting animals at the petting farm and snapping photos with the Easter Bunny, who handed out eggs and smiles all around. Our mascot, Mr. G, joined the excitement, spreading cheer and high-fives throughout the crowd.

From creative colouring contests to magical face painting, children transformed into butterflies, superheroes, and more. There were plenty of games—and lucky ballot winners too! Tasty food from PSNI kept everyone energised for the festivities.

Thank you to everyone who joined, volunteered, or helped bring the event to life. It was fantastic to see our community come together for so much laughter and fun. We can't wait to do it all again next year!



Translink Tour

A visit to York Street Station and Grand Central Station

The Tenant Voice Group had the exciting opportunity to tour two of Belfast's key transport hubs — York Street Train Station and Belfast Grand Central Station. The group found both tours highly informative and enjoyed learning more about these important parts of the city's transport network.

The day began with a tour of York Street Train Station, where the group gained insight into the station's history, operations, and future plans. After the York Street tour, the group boarded a train to Belfast Grand Central Station. The second tour offered an equally engaging experience, providing further understanding of the station's role and facilities.

The group enjoyed lunch at the historic Crown Bar, taking in its unique atmosphere and rich heritage.

A big thank you to Translink for arranging and hosting the tours. The Tenant Voice Group greatly appreciated the opportunity to explore and learn more about Belfast's transport infrastructure.



FREE BULKY WASTE COLLECTION SERVICE FOR HOUSEHOLDS

Belfast City Council offers a free service to help residents get rid of large items they don't want. It helps keep the community clean and tidy.

What is collected

You can ask for a free collection of up to seven big items like furniture and appliances. These are items too big for regular waste collection.

How to schedule

You can book a collection up to three months ahead. The service runs from Monday to Friday, except on bank or public holidays.

Other ways to get rid of items

Try these options before booking a collection:

Recycling Centres - Take items to the Council's recycling centres to reduce waste and help the environment.

Charity Donations - Donate unwanted things to local charities—some can pick up for free.

Sell or Donate Online - Sell or give away items on websites or social media.

Booking a Collection - Contact Belfast City Council if you still need a collection. You can book online at www.belfastcity.gov.uk/bins/bulky-waste or call **028 9027 0230**. Be ready to list your items (up to seven per collection).

Free collection and these options help keep your community clean and green.



Belfast
City Council



BELFAST - IMPORTANT BIN COLLECTION UPDATE. We soon won't lift bins that are: • Overfilled • Lids not fully closed • Lined with large liners From 4 August these bins will be amber-tagged, but still emptied From 29 September these bins will be red-tagged and not emptied **PLEASE REMEMBER:** • Put your bin out by 7am on collection day • Bring it back in



LIVING CONDITIONS

Many things can affect the comfort in your home. One common issue that frequently arises is mould and mildew. Condensation is what occurs when moist air comes into contact with a cold surface, for example you will note this when your windows steam up. This surface can become moist and encourage mould growth. We create moist air in our homes all the time, by cooking, showering and drying clothes indoors.

If mould grows in your home, it can give off an unpleasant smell and be unsightly but more worrying is that it could actually cause you to become ill, often worsening any conditions like asthma. It can affect the more vulnerable like children and older people.

What can I do to reduce condensation and moist air?

To avoid these health risks and prevent this moist air turning into condensation, try and keep your home as warm as possible (between 18-21 degrees on your thermostat). Make sure you air all rooms well, even in winter months.

When cooking ensure that you cover your pans with a lid to reduce moisture. Also ensure that you have opened a window, or you are using an extractor fan if you have one fitted. Close the kitchen door.

When taking a shower or a bath ensure that you turn on an extractor fan or open a window to get rid of the steam that is created. Afterwards, leave the extractor running or window open for at least 15 minutes.



If you have a tumble dryer in your property, ensure that it is vented correctly. Contact our maintenance team who can call and assess if this can be fitted to an external wall and arrange for this works to be carried out.

NEVER BLOCK OR COVER AN EXTRACTOR FAN OR VENT OR KEEP A TUMBLE DRYER VENT INSIDE.

Do not stuff your cupboards and wardrobes so full that the air cannot circulate inside.

Try to dry clothes outdoors to prevent excess moisture indoors. If you need a clothes line fitted contact our maintenance team. If you have to dry clothes inside, we advise that you open your doors or windows in these rooms if not using a vented or condenser tumble dryer.



10 pints of moisture is released into the air just from drying a batch of washing!

Make sure that your furniture is at least 5 cm away from the surrounding walls so that air can move around the property. Leaving a gap enables the air to move freely. If you don't, mould can form

at the bottom of the walls, not good in a bedroom!

Watch out for the physical signs of mould. These range from a build-up of moisture on windows or to peeling wallpaper and black spots/patches on walls.

How to treat mould and mildew

If you have areas of mould or mildew for example in your shower or behind furniture or window cills, the cheapest and most effective treatment is a diluted solution of household bleach and water. Or you can use a mould-removing spray.

If the mould is extensive we encourage you to contact our Maintenance staff for a home visit and advice and consideration of the need for professional treatment.



Further advice and support

Damp can also occur in properties, several factors can contribute to this, particularly older properties. For example water coming in from a missing or damaged roof tile, a damp proof course that has broken down etc., or an old chimney stack. If you note anything like this please contact our Maintenance staff and request a home visit for further advice and treatment to determine the cause and best course of action.

We are here to support you and provide friendly advice and to work with you to ensure your home is a comfortable and healthy a place to live as much as possible.

If you are currently struggling financially to heat your home adequately please in the first instance contact our Housing & Community Lead, Paul Stuart, for confidential advice for potential further referral for financial assistance. We work with many agencies who provide extra advice and assistance.

Maintenance

Immediate Call Out

This category of repair will be attended by the contractor within 4 hours.

These are faults which can affect the health and safety of the tenant, the general public or which could present an immediate risk to the fabric of the building. Immediate Call Out.

Examples: escape of gas or fumes and similar types of faults as the emergency category.

Emergency Repairs

The fault will be attended to and made safe within 24 hours.

These are faults which can affect the tenant or public who could be endangered or there is a risk of serious damage to the property.

Examples: serious electrical faults.

- sewage overflow into the dwelling
- securing the dwelling from vandalism or forced entry
- water penetration via the roof
- and burst water pipes, tanks and service pipes in your home

Urgent Repairs

The fault will be attended to within 4 working days.

Examples: partial loss of electrical power

- a minor leak
- insecure external window
- communal door lock

Routine Repairs

Faults in this category will be attended to within 4 weeks.

Examples: broken roof tiles, slates and lead flashing.

- clearing out rainwater goods
- easing/refitting doors or window sashes
- repairs to external render or plaster work
- repairs to solid or suspended floors or floor tiles
- repairs to internal joinery
- chimney stacks
- pots caps and cowls
- kitchen units and fittings

Emergency Out of Hours Repairs

In the event of an emergency outside of normal office working hours, tenants are requested to call Radius Connect 24's Out of Hours Service.

Freephone 0330 123 0341

This must only be used in real emergencies, for example, a burst pipe or serious electrical fault.

An emergency repair of this nature may in some cases only make safe the fault, in which case the full repair will be carried out during normal working hours.

Tumble Dryer

Do you have a similar tumble dryer? If you do and would like the machine vented outside, please contact a member of the maintenance team and arrangements will be made free of charge.



Adaptations

We understand that our tenants can be affected with health and mobility issues and will continue to support our tenants as their needs change.

The local Occupational Therapy Service (located at the Grove Well-Being Centre) provide a free assessment of your needs. For example they can recommend to us installation of level access showers, stair lifts etc. (We can only provide minor items such as additional hand rails without an OT report - contact Paul or Pat from our Maintenance Department on the office number 02890 773330.

These works support tenants to retain their independence, reduce the possibility of falls and hospital admissions and increase the ability to remain in their home for as long as possible.



HOME SECURITY

Sometimes we tend to take it for granted that our homes are secure, many burglaries are committed by opportunistic criminals. Open or unlocked doors and windows are used to gain quick and easy access to homes.

Good home security, such as using window and door locks, is the best way to reduce your chances of being burgled.

If you are a Homeowner or Landlord spending money on security for your property is a good investment. Security fittings will last a long time and can add value to your property. Make sure that your home security improvements don't stop you escaping from the property quickly if there is a fire. Safety is important while you are in the property AND security is important while away.

Preventing Burglary

- Check all doors and windows for any weaknesses
- Fit mortise locks to all front and back doors and locks to all downstairs windows or windows which are easy to reach
- Fit barrel locks to the top and bottom of doors
- Make sure you keep the appropriate keys nearby in case of an emergency
- Keep your house and car keys safe and away from doors and windows
- Ensure your burglar alarm is installed properly and works. If you don't have a burglar alarm consider installing one
- When you are away from home, use timer switches to turn on some lights when it goes dark
- Make sure you have up-to-date contents insurance
- Cancel any milk or newspaper deliveries when you go away
- Before you go out, go into each room in the house and make sure all the windows are tightly shut and locked. A burglar may be less likely to enter your home if a window needs to be smashed. Check all doors leading into your home are secure and locked.
- If you have a garage, put your car inside if you are not using it
- Recent improvements in car security mean that the easiest way for a thief to steal a car is to break into your house and steal the keys for it therefore keep car keys where they will not be easily found

- Ensure your main garage door is shut and locked.
- If there are any bicycles or toys sitting around the outside of the house, put them away

Protect Your Keys

- Always keep your keys safe
- Never give keys to workmen or tradesmen
- Change your locks if you think other people might have copies



Book a home safety check for families

Belfast City Council offers free home safety checks for all residents with young children living in the Belfast electoral area. This service is provided by Belfast City Council.

The family home safety check offers tips on all aspects of home safety, as well as specialist advice on topics like heating and energy saving. A room-by-room inspection usually takes around 60 minutes and our advisors can:

- Show you the potential risk areas in your home, for example blind cords or poisoning risks.
- Provide tailored advice on how to make your home safer.
- Arrange for safety equipment to be delivered to your home (subject to eligibility and stock availability). For example, a free heat pouch to put heated styling tools immediately out of young children's reach.

To find out more and to book, email envhealth@belfastcity.gov.uk to request a home safety check. Belfast City Council will send you an application form to complete and return.

Migration Notice Letter

The following benefits and tax credits are ending and will be replaced by Universal Credit.

Since May 2024, the Department for Communities has been sending Migration Notice letters to people who currently get one or more of these benefits or tax credits:

- Child Tax Credits
- Working Tax Credits
- Income Support
- Income-Based Jobseeker's Allowance
- Income-Related Employment & Support Allowance
- Housing Benefit (if you are working age and rent a home, excluding payments for rates)

If you get other benefits (such as Personal Independence Payment (PIP), Carer's Allowance (CA), Disability Living Allowance (DLA), Child Benefit, New Style JSA, or New Style ESA), you will only get a Migration Notice letter if you also receive one of the benefits or tax credits listed above.

If You Receive a Migration Notice Letter

If you get a Migration Notice letter, you have three months to make a claim for Universal Credit before your current benefits or tax credits stop.

If you do not make a claim by the deadline on the letter, your payments will end the day before that deadline.

If You Haven't Received a Migration Notice Letter

If you haven't received a Migration Notice letter, you do not need to do anything yet. You will get the letter when it is your time to move over to Universal Credit.

If you are thinking about claiming Universal Credit before you get a Migration Notice letter, please contact our Housing & Community Lead, Paul Stuart.



How to Make a Universal Credit Claim

- You must first create a secure Universal Credit online account.
- You have 28 days to submit your claim after you create the account. Your claim starts from the date you send it.
- If you don't submit your claim within 28 days, you'll need to set up a new account.
- Your first payment will be about five weeks after you submit your claim.

You can use your online account to:

- Check and update information about your claim
- Contact Universal Credit staff

Messages will be answered as soon as possible during business hours.

What You Need to Make a Claim

- Your email address
- Your bank or building society account details for payments
- Proof of identity (such as a UK driving licence and a household bill)
- Information about your income (from work or elsewhere)
- Details about any savings, investments, or other assets
- Any other benefits you receive
- Information about your housing costs (including service charges, but not rates), and your landlord's details (if you have one)
- Details of everyone who lives in your home

Reporting a Change in Your Circumstances

If your circumstances change, sign in to your Universal Credit account to report it right away.

Please also let our housing team know, as this may affect your Universal Credit payments.

It's important to report any changes as soon as they happen.

Delays could mean you're paid too much and have to pay money back. Changes can affect your Universal Credit for the whole monthly assessment period, not just from the day you report them.

Examples of Changes You Must Report:

- Starting or finishing a job
- Having a child
- Moving in with a partner
- Becoming a carer for a child or disabled person
- Changes to your child's education or training (if aged 16–19)
- Changing your mobile number or email address
- Moving to a new address
- Changes to your rent, bank details, savings, or investments
- Changes to your health or becoming too ill to work
- If a medical professional says you are nearing the end of life
- Changes in your earnings (if self-employed)
- Changes to your immigration status (if you're not a British citizen)

Need Help with Universal Credit?

We can help! Contact our Housing & Community Lead, Paul Stuart, to arrange support or refer you to the North Belfast Advice Partnership.

- **Drop-in clinic:** Tuesdays, 9:30am–12:30pm at our office
- **Book an appointment (Wed/Thu):** Phone the Vine Centre on 028 9035 1020

Remember: Universal Credit is paid monthly in arrears. Your first payment may take up to five weeks from the date you apply, so it's important to claim as soon as possible.

If you have any questions, get in touch—we're here to help!



Tenancy Fraud

Tenancy Fraud and Subletting of GCHA properties

Grove Community Housing Association are committed to tackling tenancy fraud to ensure our properties are used to their full potential by those designated to reside within them.

Addressing tenancy fraud can only be achieved with the support of our tenants and the information we receive. If you suspect that someone is committing tenancy fraud or subletting their home to someone else, please contact us immediately.

Tenancy Fraud has a major impact on all those currently awaiting a new home. To report any suspected Tenancy Fraud, please contact our Housing & Community Lead, Paul Stuart on **028 9077 3330**.



Complaints

How to make a complaint

Contact Housing & Community Lead, Paul Stuart on **028 9077 3330** or email housing@groveha.org.uk.

Domestic abuse

Domestic abuse can take many forms and can affect anyone

Domestic abuse can be broadly defined as a pattern of threatening, violent or abusive behaviours (including coercive or controlling conduct) by a current or former intimate partner or family member.

This behaviour may be psychological, virtual, physical, verbal, sexual, financial or emotional in nature and inflicted on anyone (irrespective of age, ethnicity, religion, gender, gender identity, sexual orientation or any form of disability).

No-one should be subjected to any form of domestic abuse.

Remember, you are not to blame for any abuse that is happening to you.

Sexual abuse

If you have been sexually assaulted you can report this to the police directly who will arrange for you to visit the Rowan.

The Rowan is a specialist regional Sexual Assault Referral Centre which provides a range of services for people who have been raped or sexually assaulted.

Its services are available for men, women, children and young people.

Alternatively you can also access the Rowan directly via its contact number.

Children

Domestic abuse can have an impact on children (including unborn children) which may not be immediately obvious. Early intervention will ensure that any impact is kept to a minimum.

It is police policy to share information with the local Family and Child Care Manager where children are resident or present at home at the time of a domestic incident or where the victim is pregnant.

Support agencies

There are several organisations which can help by offering emotional and practical support

24 Hour Free Phone Domestic and Sexual Violence Helpline

Freephone Helpline 0808 802 1414
(free from all landlines and mobiles)

The 24 Hour Domestic and Sexual Violence Helpline is available 24 hours, seven days a week to all women and men affected by domestic violence and sexual violence.

The Rowan

Freephone Helpline 0800 389 4424
(from all landlines only)

See 'Sexual Abuse' section for more information.

Victim Support

028 90 244 039

Victim Support NI helps people affected by crime. It offers a free and confidential service, whether or not a crime has been reported and regardless of how long ago the event took place.

You can find out more about the warning signs of Domestic Abuse here: www.psni.police.uk/crime/domestic-abuse/domestic-abuse-behaviours/

NON-FATAL STRANGULATION

IF YOU INTENTIONALLY RESTRICT SOMEONE'S BREATHING, THIS IS A CRIME.
BE PREPARED TO FACE UP TO FOURTEEN YEARS IN PRISON.

psni.police.uk 
Report online. Call 101. In an emergency call 999

we care
we listen
we act



Police Service
of Northern Ireland

No Place for Hate at Grove!

Everyone at Grove Community Housing deserves to feel safe and happy at home. We stand together against hate in all its forms—no one should be targeted for who they are.

What is a Hate Crime?

A hate crime is when someone is picked on, bullied, or hurt **because of their:**

- Disability
- Race or background
- Religion or beliefs
- Sexual orientation or gender identity (LGBT)
- Political opinion

Why report Hate Crime?

Reporting hate crimes protects our community and supports those affected. Even if you don't want to press charges, letting us or the police know really helps. All reports are kept private.

Keeping People Safe



How to report a Hate Crime

- **Call the Police (PSNI) at 101** (non-emergency)
 - Minicom number for hearing impaired: **028 9090 1246**
- **Online:** Use the True Vision Reporting Form (sent directly to PSNI)
- PSNI Hate Crime Advice & Information

Contact Grove Community Housing

- Call us on **028 9077 3330** (office hours)
- Out-of-hours emergencies: **0330 123 0341**
- Visit our office or email us

In an emergency, call 999

- **Anonymously:** Call Crimestoppers on **0800 555 111**



If you'd prefer, a friend, family member, or support worker can help you report.

What will Grove Community Housing do?

- Keep your report confidential
- Work closely with the PSNI and support groups
- Offer language or other support if needed
- Remove hateful graffiti from our properties
- Take hate crime seriously—any tenant found guilty of a hate crime by the PSNI risks losing their tenancy

Reporting hate crime helps the police spot patterns, support victims, and prosecute offenders. Even small reports make a big difference in keeping our community safe.

Let's work together to keep Grove a friendly, welcoming, and safe place for all!

Come On In: Enjoy Our Warm Space and Get Expert Support and Advice!

We currently offer a Warm Space area in our office, **Tuesday – Thursday from 9.30am to 4.30pm** for all residents and members of the community. Why not pop by for a cup of tea or coffee (hot chocolate for the kids) and enjoy the warmth and comfort of our office. There is some great work underway locally by community organisations offering various drop-in sessions and help with essentials throughout the year.

We are delighted to have **Marie Fennell from North Belfast Advice Partnership** based at the office. Marie has a vast knowledge of the welfare benefit system and has been providing this service since 2011. The main focus of Marie's role is to assist service users with benefit entitlement and information. Marie also aids with completing application forms. Marie's highlights of her job are being able to empower people to apply and manage their benefits with her advice and support. Marie takes great delight when people receive good outcomes especially when benefits have been identified which in turn makes their life's a lot easier. Should you wish to arrange an appointment with Marie, she is available during the drop-in Service on **Tuesday 9.30am – 12.30pm and from 9.30am Wednesday & Thursday** (Appointments only). Please contact the office for further information.



Need a Hand with Groceries? The Scullery is Here to Help!

Did you know there's a friendly Social Supermarket (Food Bank) called **"The Scullery"** right here in our community? Loughview Community Action Partnership runs The Scullery from Mount Vernon Community House on Shore Road, and it's here to support families across North and Lower North Belfast with food and everyday essentials when times are tough.

If you, or someone you know, could use a little extra help, getting in touch is easy and confidential. Simply speak to Marie from North Belfast Advice Partnership at our Grove Housing office (Tuesday to Thursday), or have a chat with Paul Stuart, our Housing & Community Lead. They'll help with any questions and can refer you to The Scullery if needed.

Don't hesitate to reach out—this is what your community is all about!



Help a Neighbour: Let's Look Out for Each Other

When the weather turns harsh, it can be extra challenging for some of our neighbours—especially those who are elderly, have a disability, or are housebound. A quick check-in or a friendly chat can make all the difference and brighten someone's day.

There are lots of little ways you can help:

- Pick up groceries or prescriptions if someone can't get out
- Offer to take out rubbish bins or bring in post
- Check if they need anything from the shops
- Pop round for a friendly chat or a cup of tea
- Help clear a path or steps if it's icy or slippery

Even the smallest gesture can mean a lot to someone. Let's keep our community warm, caring, and connected—whatever the weather!



TOP TIPS FOR FIRE SAFETY AT HOME

HERE ARE TEN TOP TIPS FOR FIRE SAFETY AT HOME:

1. FIT A SMOKE ALARM AND TEST IT REGULARLY:

Smoke alarms are essential for early detection of fires. Test them regularly and ensure they conform to safety standards.

2. TAKE CARE WHEN COOKING:

Cooking-related fires are common, so always stay attentive in the kitchen and keep flammable items away from heat sources.

3. PLAN AN ESCAPE ROUTE:

Prepare and discuss an escape plan with your family, and ensure everyone knows the best routes to exit the home in case of a fire.

4. STORE MATCHES & ELECTRICAL ITEMS SAFELY:

Keep matches and electrical items away from children and flammable materials to prevent accidents.

5. AVOID OVERLOADING ELECTRICAL OUTLETS:

Plugging too many appliances into one outlet can lead to overheating and fire hazards, so distribute the load across different outlets.

6. FIT A CARBON MONOXIDE DETECTOR:

If you have a gas boiler/appliance or an open fire or stove make sure you have a carbon monoxide detector fitted.

7. ARRANGE A FIRE SAFETY CHECK:

Many Fire and Rescue Services offer fire safety risk assessments, which can provide invaluable insights into potential fire hazards in your home.

8. KEEP AN EYE ON HEATERS, STOVES & FIREPLACES:

Ensure that combustible materials are kept at a safe distance from heat sources to prevent accidental fires.

9. QUIT SMOKING INDOORS:

Smoking is a common cause of fires, so consider quitting or smoke outside to reduce the risk of fire in your home.

10. HAVE A FIRE EXTINGUISHER:

It's advisable to have a fire extinguisher at home to tackle small fires before they escalate. Make sure you know how to use it safely.

BY FOLLOWING THESE TIPS, YOU CAN SIGNIFICANTLY REDUCE THE RISK OF FIRE IN YOUR HOME AND ENSURE THE SAFETY OF YOUR FAMILY AND PROPERTY.

BEDTIME CHECKLIST

You are more at risk from a fire when you are asleep. So it's a good idea to check your home before you go to bed.

Close inside doors at night to stop fire from spreading. ☐

Turn off and unplug electrical appliances unless they need to be left on eg. Fridge/Freezer. ☐

Check your cooker is turned off. ☐

Don't leave the washing machine on. ☐

Turn heaters off and put up fireguards. ☐

Put candles and cigarettes out properly. ☐

Make sure that exits are kept clear. ☐

Keep door and window keys where everyone can find them. ☐

IF A FIRE DEVELOPS IN YOUR HOME, REMEMBER TO: GET OUT, STAY OUT, AND CALL THE FIRE BRIGADE OUT

WATCH OUT 

CARBON MONOXIDE KILLS

FOR INFORMATION CALL

0800 0320 121

www.hseni.gov.uk/watchout

CARBON MONOXIDE KILLS! YOU CAN'T SEE IT, TASTE IT, OR SMELL IT

If it's not
PEE, POO
or **PAPER**
it will block
the pipes



93% of the material causing sewer blockages is made up of wipes.

This includes a high proportion of baby wipes - which are not designed to be flushed.

DON'T FLUSH



WIPES



SANITARY ITEMS
(PADS & TAMPONS)



COTTON
BUDS

Find out more at
niwater.com

northern ireland
water

Delivering what matters



New Text Message Service from Grove

Your Tenant Voice Group has been working with Grove Community Housing Association to help improve how we keep in touch with you. One of their suggestions was to make it easier for tenants to know what's happening with repairs. We listened—and now we're starting a new text message service to help with that.

First Step: Repairs Updates

The first part of this new service is all about repairs. When you report a repair and it's sent to a contractor, you'll get a text message from us. This message will include:

- The job number for your repair
- The contractor
- The date you should expect the work to be done by

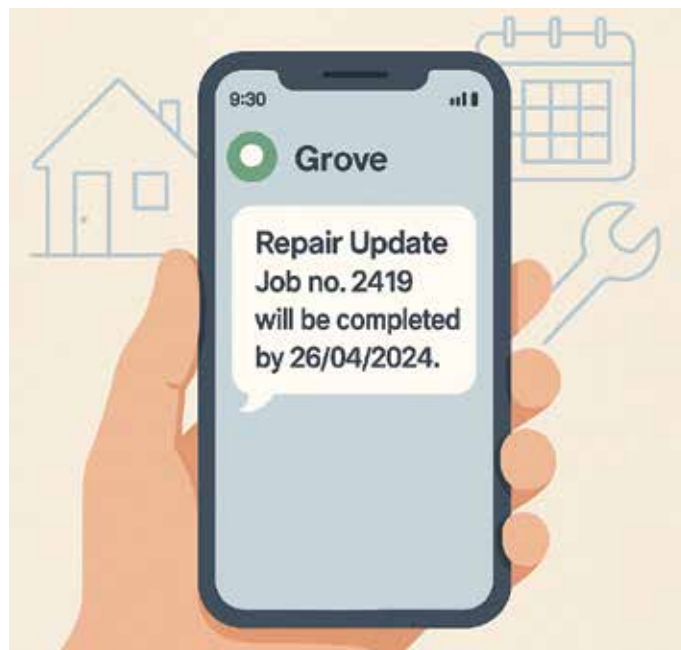
This means you won't have to call us to find out what's going on—we'll send the key details straight to your phone.

Save this number

All messages will come from this number:

07418 347196

Please save it in your phone as "Grove" so you know it's from us. That way, when you get a message, you'll know it's about your home and not a scam or spam.



What's next?

This is just the first phase of the new service. We're starting with repairs, but we hope to add more updates in the future to keep you even better informed.

Thanks to the Tenant Voice Group for helping shape this idea—and thank you for being part of the Grove community.

Introducing Our Enhanced Lettable Standard: Your Feedback in Action!

At Grove Community Housing Association (GCHA), we're committed to providing safe, clean, and secure homes for all our tenants. We're excited to announce the launch of our new Lettable Standard, which outlines exactly what new tenants can expect from their new home before they move in.

This enhanced standard directly incorporates valuable feedback from our Tenants Voice Group, ensuring that our approach truly reflects the needs and priorities of our residents.

What's does this include?

All newly let homes will be safe, clean, and secure, with all essential safety checks (gas, electrical) completed. We've committed to completing urgent repairs beforehand and, where feasible, installing a shower over the bath. For non-urgent repairs, our Housing & Community Lead, will provide clear timeframes if they are scheduled post-move to avoid delays.

Key information & support from GCHA:

We'll provide you with a Tenant's Handbook (detailing repair reporting, maintenance responsibilities, and contact information), guidance on your heating system, access to your home's Energy Performance Certificate (EPC), and a follow-up visit within six weeks to ensure your satisfaction.



Your role in a smooth move:

We also highlight key responsibilities for new tenants, such as identifying utility suppliers, ensuring gas cooker installations are by Gas Safe engineers, updating benefits, and seeking GCHA permission for any property alterations. Remember, properties are not generally redecorated before move-in, but decorations will be of an acceptable standard.

This new standard reflects our ongoing commitment to transparency and tenant satisfaction. We believe it will contribute to a smoother and more positive moving experience for everyone joining Grove Community Housing Association.



Energy efficient behaviour savings

Washing and drying

- Setting your washing machine to wash at 30 degrees rather than higher temperatures will save around £10 a year on energy bills and around 12kg of carbon dioxide.
- Setting your washing machine to wash at 30 degrees uses around 57% less electricity than washing at higher temperatures.
- You can save on average £40 a year on your electricity bill, and 50kg carbon dioxide in emissions, by line drying clothes instead of using a tumble dryer during the summer.
- Only filling the kettle up with as much water as you need could save around £8 in energy bills a year.

Thermostat

Your room thermostat switches your heating system on and off according to the set temperature. A common misconception is that turning your thermostat up will heat up your home quicker; but all that will do is heat your home to a higher temperature at the same rate. Insulation increases the speed your home heats up as less heat is being lost through the building.

- Turning your central heating thermostat down by 1 degree could save you £80 and 300kg of carbon dioxide every year.

Switching it off

Avoiding standby and turning appliances off when you're not using them could save £40 and up to 45kg of carbon dioxide ever year.

- Turning off your lights when you don't need them could save you around £14 on your annual energy bills, and avoid 16kg of carbon dioxide emissions a year.

Home appliances Cold appliances

- The energy label for cold appliances has rescaled; that means some of the appliances have had their energy ratings changed. Make sure you keep a look out for the new label that has the UK flag and the word **ENERG+** at the top.
- Check the new energy ratings when looking for a new cold appliance. The new labels go from A to G with A being the most energy efficient; this means they will use less electricity, they will be more sustainable and cost you less to run.
- When buying a new freezer, choosing a E-rated freezer over a G-rated model will save you around £25 in energy bills and 25kg carbon dioxide a year.
- When buying a new fridge, choosing a D-rated fridge over a G-rated model will save you around £10 in energy bills and 11kg carbon dioxide a year.
- When buying a new fridge freezer, choosing a D-rated fridge freezer over a G-rated model will save you around £30 in energy bills and 30kg carbon dioxide a year.

Wet appliances

- The energy label for most wet appliances has rescaled; that means some of the appliances have had their energy ratings changed. Make sure you keep a look out for the new label that has the UK flag and the word **ENERG+** at the top. This new energy label applies to dishwashers and washing machines. Tumble driers are on a A+++ -G scale, but are due to be rescaled in late 2021.
- Check the new energy ratings when looking for a new wet appliance. The new labels go from A to G with A being the most energy efficient; this means they will use less electricity, costing you less to run. Tumble drier labels go from A+++ to D, with A+++ being the most energy efficient.
- When buying a new washing machine, choosing an A-rated washing machine over a D-rated one could save you around £8 and 9kg carbon dioxide a year.
- Choosing a D-rated dishwasher over a G-rated one could save you around £14 and 16kg carbon dioxide a year.
- Choosing an A+++ non-vented tumble dryer over a A-rated one could save you around £35 and 40kg carbon dioxide a year.

Home computing Computers

- Choosing a laptop over a desktop and reducing standby could save up to £25 and 25kg of carbon dioxide every year.

Tablets

- When turned on, tablets use on average 68% less power than laptops.

Lighting

- In 2019, 47% of light bulbs in homes were energy saving bulbs (combination of compact fluorescent lamps and LEDs), 51% were halogens and 3% were traditional incandescent light bulbs.
- LEDs are the most energy efficient bulbs you can buy, followed by compact fluorescent lamps. Whilst halogen bulbs can still be bought in the UK, they have much lower efficiencies than their LED or other energy saving equivalents.

LEDs

- By replacing all the remaining standard incandescent and halogen bulbs in your home with energy saving LEDs, the average household could save around £35 a year from your energy bills, and 40kg of carbon dioxide every year.

Electronics TV

- Choosing an F-rated 65"TV over a G-rated 65"TV could save you almost £25 and 30kg carbon dioxide a year.

In general, smaller TVs use less energy. Choosing a 32" LCD over a 42" LCD TV could save £15 and 16kg of carbon dioxide a year.

Water Showers

- You could save around £25 off their yearly gas bills by replacing your inefficient shower head with a water efficient one .
- Spending one minute less in the shower each day could save as much as £15 a year in the average household.

Washing up

- Using a bowl to wash up rather than leaving the hot tap running saves a lot of water; a typical 10 litre washing up bowl fills up in just 95 seconds.

Toilets

- By fitting a dual flush mechanism to an old toilet, a four person household could save over 50,000 litres of water a year.

Electricity and behaviour

Householders can reduce their electricity bills using the following tips:

Standby

By avoiding standby and turning off devices when not in use, the average household could save £40 off their annual electricity bill.

Lighting

Turning off your lights when you don't need them could save you around £14 a year.

LEDs are the most efficient lighting technology; they are available for most types of light fittings.

Line-dry clothes

You can save on average £40 a year on your electricity bill by line drying clothes instead of using a tumble dryer during the summer.

Television

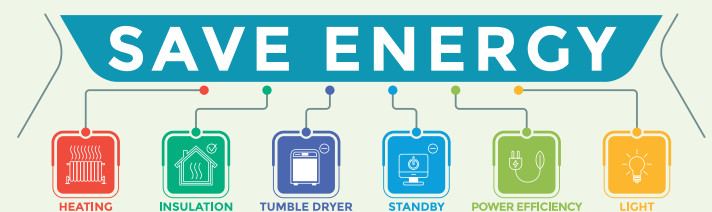
Choosing an F-rated 65"TV over a G-rated 65"TV could save you almost £25 a year.

Fridge-freezer

When buying a new fridge freezer, choosing a D-rated fridge freezer over a G-rated model will save you around £30 in energy bills a year.

Tumble dryer

Choosing an A+++ tumble dryer over an A+ -rated model could save you around £35 a year off your energy bills.



ROOF AND PATH CLEANING UPDATE

Roof and Path Cleaning Programme

Recently, Grove Housing completed a cyclical maintenance programme focused on cleaning the roofs, gutters, and paths across our housing stock. This effort, costing £90,333, aimed to ensure our properties remain in good condition and free from debris.

Tenant Feedback

Our tenants have noticed the improvements. Here are a few comments:

“The roof cleaning has improved the appearance of our home.”

“The paths are now safer and cleaner.”

We remain committed to regular maintenance to enhance the safety and comfort of our tenants. Thank you for your continued support.

LOUGHVIEW CAR PARK LIGHTING UPGRADE

We are pleased to share with all Grove residents, particularly those living in the Loughview Apartments that the outdoor car park lighting has been successfully upgraded just in time for the festive season. This project was completed shortly before Christmas, ensuring improved visibility and safety for residents and visitors alike during the darker winter evenings.

As part of the upgrade, an experienced electrical contractor carried out the professional installation of six brand-new LED streetlights using the existing lamp posts. The enhanced lighting now provides better illumination across the car park, helping to create a safer and more welcoming environment.

In addition to improved lighting quality, the new LED fixtures are also a more environmentally responsible choice. They consume significantly less energy than the previous conventional lighting system, supporting our ongoing commitment to sustainability and reducing our carbon footprint.



BRIGHTER, BOLDER, BETTER: CHECK OUT OUR NEW SIGNAGE

We’ve recently installed new signs at our office, thanks to the team at Sign Studio. These modern signs, featuring our logo and colours, make our office easier to find and brighten up York Road. Made from high-quality materials, they’re built to last and enhance our professional image.

We chose Sign Studio for their great reputation and expertise. They worked closely with us to bring our vision to life, and the installation was smooth without disrupting our work. The new signs also include three EV charging panels.

We invite you to come see the new look in person. A big thank you to Sign Studio and everyone involved in this project—we hope the improved signage helps visitors, partners, and community members find us more easily.



Word Hunt at Grove!

Find the words in the grid by looking for them in all directions including backwards and diagonally.

W	W	Z	M	H	G	R	O	V	E	P	R	R	W	A	F	N	E	P	A	I	J	H	Q	J	Z
E	Y	E	P	E	M	P	N	R	N	P	Y	A	Y	Z	N	E	W	S	L	E	T	T	E	R	T
J	B	M	T	L	F	H	G	P	H	L	O	T	T	I	E	S	L	O	U	N	G	E	D	K	V
Q	T	Z	E	P	V	Y	Q	J	E	I	O	V	B	U	L	K	Y	W	A	S	T	E	X	Q	M
O	W	I	N	I	D	M	R	R	S	J	N	C	X	L	F	Z	S	A	F	E	T	Y	G	H	Y
Z	S	Q	A	N	O	A	H	E	U	N	W	E	L	C	O	M	E	J	K	E	S	W	T	L	T
X	Q	S	N	G	H	U	O	Z	L	O	O	P	F	T	H	G	A	K	H	K	J	I	Y	F	I
A	P	U	T	H	V	O	Z	R	U	L	B	I	B	X	G	Z	N	H	D	Y	W	K	J	B	R
A	V	S	V	A	J	G	U	H	K	M	U	H	T	A	U	A	C	G	L	G	K	O	V	Z	U
Q	Q	T	O	N	N	M	S	S	R	R	F	C	G	I	W	G	H	A	M	N	L	A	I	Z	C
N	E	A	I	D	Z	S	A	S	I	P	O	M	S	I	D	P	H	A	S	E	D	U	D	A	E
T	H	I	C	S	L	K	Q	C	Q	N	C	Y	H	E	E	N	I	J	T	T	V	T	V	B	S
N	S	N	E	E	A	F	X	H	O	O	G	S	S	M	H	N	O	T	P	A	N	O	L	H	E
A	W	A	G	R	L	H	S	O	M	M	G	A	N	L	T	T	A	C	K	M	J	E	R	D	M
N	W	B	R	V	T	I	M	M	Y	N	F	V	S	E	S	B	N	S	G	O	J	C	V	G	O
E	A	I	O	I	R	J	U	O	I	T	C	O	N	S	L	N	I	O	U	N	F	K	X	E	H
T	R	L	U	C	J	N	E	V	C	A	E	A	R	E	O	P	O	M	I	P	I	R	W	I	B
S	M	I	P	E	I	P	A	A	K	V	N	F	S	T	Z	C	I	I	D	S	P	V	M	Q	O
U	S	T	S	T	G	S	R	K	M	C	O	T	A	Z	H	A	I	I	T	B	U	O	I	O	B
F	P	Y	Y	E	Y	E	E	T	E	T	A	S	G	S	Y	U	U	A	W	A	B	L	R	L	Q
A	A	K	C	G	I	C	E	M	S	N	X	K	U	T	E	R	D	Z	T	T	T	R	C	T	E
L	C	L	R	F	I	K	R	U	D	G	J	K	P	R	E	R	L	D	T	I	T	P	W	N	X
T	E	E	W	V	C	G	K	A	M	P	L	O	G	Q	W	A	I	V	M	C	O	W	A	V	I
S	N	Y	D	C	L	O	R	Q	S	O	H	H	K	Y	K	M	F	S	G	D	N	Z	D	Z	
E	Y	A	H	C	T	D	G	C	R	L	W	E	L	L	B	E	I	N	G	W	L	A	X	B	A
P	A	R	T	N	E	R	S	H	I	P	W	C	C	U	Z	L	R	S	J	C	T	B	X	M	C

ADAPTATIONS
ADVICE
BULKY WASTE
CARE
COMFORT
COMMUNITY
ENERGY SAVINGS
EVENTS

FIRE SAFETY
GROVE
HELPING HAND SERVICE
HOME SECURITY
HOUSING ASSOCIATION
INCLUSION
LETTABLE STANDARD
LIVING CONDITIONS

LOTTIES LOUNGE
MR G
MAINTENANCE
NEIGHBOUR
NEWSLETTER
PARTNERSHIP
SAFETY
SUPPORT

TEAM
TENANT
TENANT VOICE GROUP
THE SCULLERY
WARM SPACE
WELCOME
WELLBEING
YORK ROAD

EVENTS CALENDAR

January 	February 19 February 2025 Tenant Voice Meeting 25 February 2025 Spring Event Planning	March 24 March 2025 Tour- York Street Train Station/Belfast Grand Central Station	April 16 April 2025 Spring Event
May 28 May 2025 Tenant Voice Meeting	June 	July 2 July 2025 Summer Event Planning	August 20 August 2025 Summer Event 27 August 2025 Tenant Voice Meeting
September 3 September 2025 Good Relations Week Planning 15 September 2025 Autumn Event Planning	October 6 & 7 October 2025 Tenant Engagement Conference 13 - 19 October 2025 Good Relations Week 29 October 2025 Autumn Event	November 12 November 2025 Seniors Breakfast	December 3 December 2025 Tenant Voice Meeting/Decorating Christmas Tree 10 December 2025 Christmas Event

GCHA is excited to share our 2025 events calendar! Connect with neighbours and join the fun. Follow us on Facebook for updates.



Grove Community
HOUSING ASSOCIATION



Grove Community
HOUSING ASSOCIATION

Contact Details

Registered Office

171 York Road, Belfast BT15 3HB

Telephone: (028) 9077 3330

Out of Hours Repairs Line

0330 1230 341

E-mail: info@groveha.org.uk

Website: www.groveha.org.uk

f [facebook.com/
grovecommunityhousing](https://facebook.com/grovecommunityhousing)

USEFUL CONTACT NUMBERS

Gas emergency service if you smell gas	0800 002 001
Electricity supply faults	03457 643 643
Police Service of N Ireland – emergency	999
Police Service of N Ireland – non-emergency	101
Crimestoppers	0800 555 111
NI Water – emergency/flooding	03457 440 088
Housing Benefit	03448 920 902
Make the Call (Benefits Helpline)	0800 232 1271
Universal Credit	0800 012 1331
The Vine Centre - Benefits Advice	028 9035 1020
Housing Rights Service	028 9024 5460
Women's Aid Helpline	0808 802 1414
City Council: Noise Hotline	028 9037 3006
Anti-social behaviour officer	028 9027 0469
Reporting dog fouling	028 9027 0431
Waste collection	028 9027 0230
Phoenix Gas	03454 55 55 55
Firmus Energy	0800 032 4567
Power NI	03457 455 455
Budget Energy	0800 012 1177
Click Energy	0800 107 0732
Airtricity	08454 555555
Children's Helpline	0800 1111
Nexus - Sexual Abuse Helpline	028 9032 6803
MacMillan Cancer Support	028 9070 8610
Lifeline (Northern Ireland)	0808 808 8000